



leaves and feed with high nitrogen fertilizer. Remove any flower buds that appear.

HARVESTING

Young, tender kale leaves can be harvested as required from cut-and-come-again crops and will resprout, producing new growth. Cut leaves when they are about 4 in (10 cm) in length and harvest until plants become bitter.

Fully grown kale can be left in the ground and harvested as required. Kale is one of the hardiest winter crops and can be left in the ground at temperatures as low as 5°F (-15°C).

PESTS AND DISEASES

Kale is less susceptible to the problems that plague other brassicas (see pp.246–7), but you may find that fine netting is needed to deter birds and butterflies. Rotate crops—plant where peas or beans have previously grown.



Netting will prevent attacks from birds.